

frontmatter, the screens

Thirty-four screens on desktop and phone, and what is on each.
The companion to the product plan, revised after the independent audit.

Thirty-four screens, each on desktop and on the phone, and what is on every one of them. The argument for each decision is in the product plan. This sheet is the product as a person will meet it: sign in, write, decide, share, bring things in, and use it everywhere.

10

sections

2.6k

words

34

screens

print

17 Sept 2026

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PART ONE. WHAT IS IN THE PRODUCT

§1 In one page

frontmatter is a markdown editor for people whose documents are increasingly written with, and for, AI agents. One account on the web, the desktop and the phone. Every feature is free. Only quantities are capped.

Area | What is in it The door | Sign in with Google or GitHub, one tap. Home with five ways to start. Settings on the account Writing | Markdown mode and Doc mode in one Live editor. Four modes: Edit, Live, Reading, Split. The twelve-button toolbar. Tabs. A rail with the outline, tags, backlinks and comments in it. Dark mode Help while writing | An AI box on an empty document. Seven AI verbs on a selection with accept and reject in place. A problems panel and a formatter. A health panel for instruction files Blocks and views | Tables, callouts, Mermaid, maths, a chart block that reads the table above it, an Excalidraw drawing block. View a document as a page, a flow, slides, a mind map, a kanban or an outline. The project map Ideas | A separate tab. Ideas listed with their state. An industry template. Three depths: Low free, Medium and High on Pro. A blueprint of fifteen files in a skill folder, with a consistency check, an unlisted link, a hash printed on the page and a kickoff prompt that checks it Sharing | People with roles. Links that expire, and on Pro need a password. Published pages with a markdown twin. Live editing with three people on Free. A review queue for every change by a person, an AI edit or an agent. Document history In and out | Drop files or a whole folder. Import from Obsidian, Notion, Google Docs or Word. Connect GitHub as an app and Google Drive as two-way sync. Export to markdown, HTML, Word or PDF Everywhere | Offline in the browser. The desktop app with files on disk and no document limit. The phone with a bottom bar, drawers, quick capture and the share sheet Money | Free: 50 cloud documents, 1 GB of uploads, 5 published pages, 3 live collaborators, 7-day history, 1 repository with 20 pushes, 1 Low blueprint plus 10 AI edits a month. Pro at ₹299 a month: unlimited, 90-day history, password links, Medium and High, 100 edits and 5 blueprints on Claude, the portfolio Later | The portfolio at frontmatter.in/@handle, the MCP server and API, Team, a custom domain, kanban and chart blocks

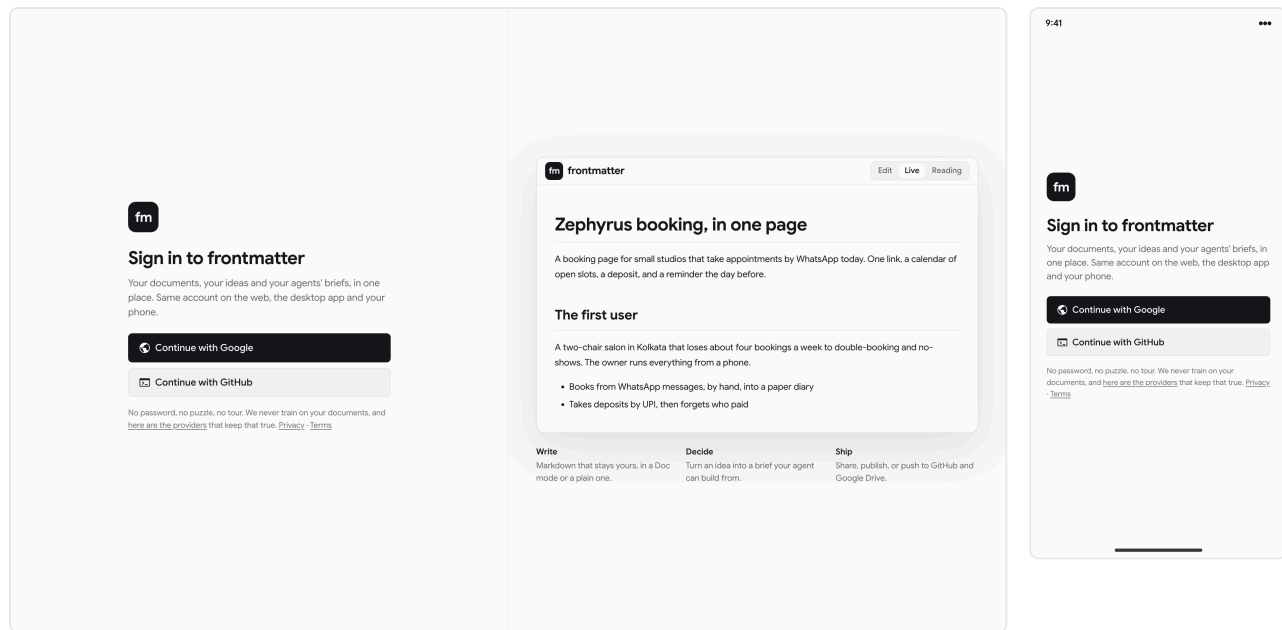
§2 Reading the screens

Each screen shows the desktop at 1,440 by 900 and the phone at 390 by 844, rendered from the same design tokens as the shipped app. The phone follows the shipped code: a 52 px bar, the editor full width, and the tree and the right pane as drawers. The bottom bar carries five actions, Home, Search, AI, Outline and More, at thumb height.

PART TWO. THE SCREENS

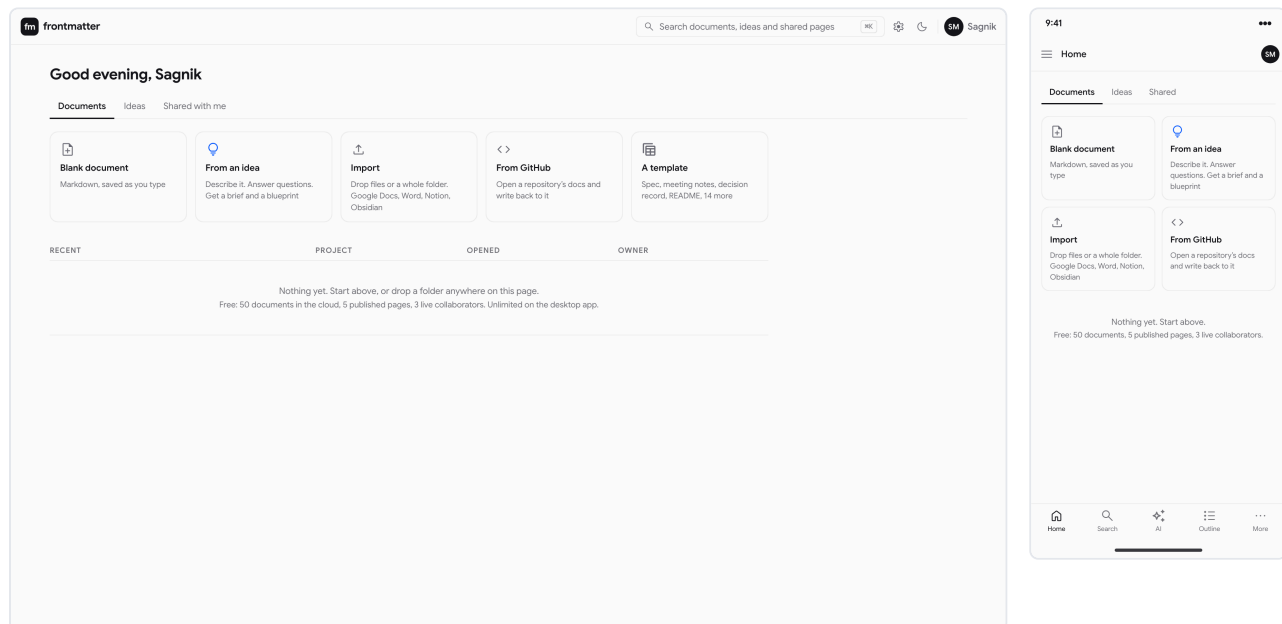
§3 Getting in

S01. Sign in



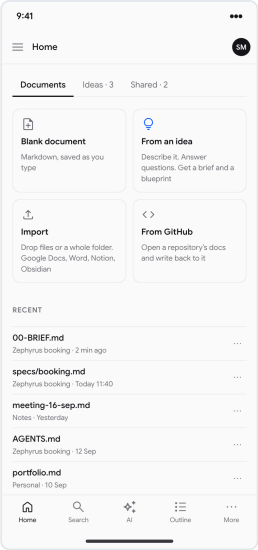
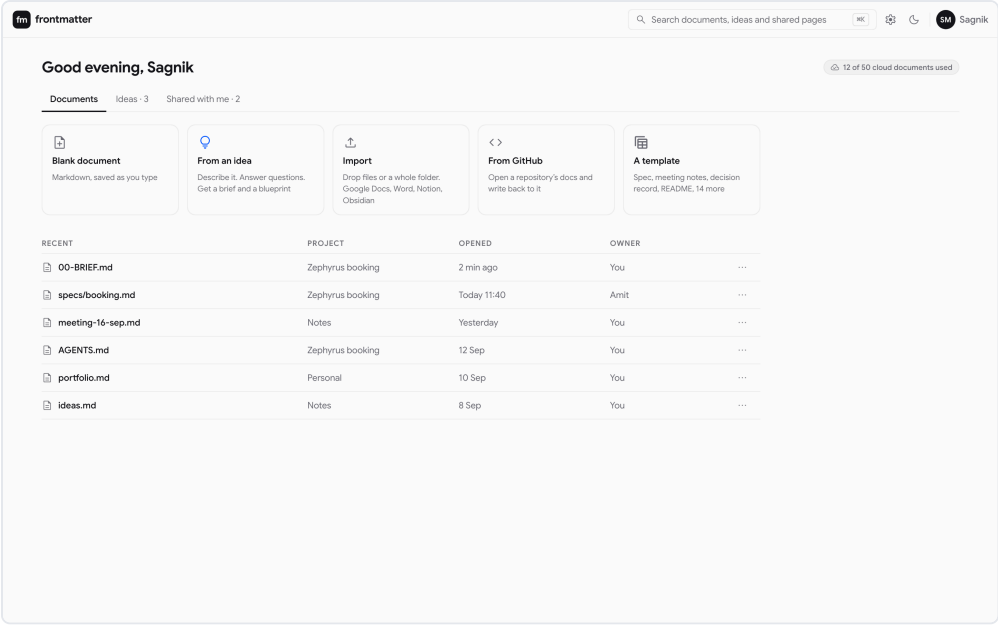
- The wordmark, one line of promise, Continue with Google, Continue with GitHub.
- The fine print says what we do not do: no password, no puzzle, no tour, no training on documents, and links the provider list that makes that true.
- Privacy and Terms link to pages that serve without an account (F054). The right half shows the editor once, so the page is not a wall.

S02. Home, first time



- Five ways to start: a blank document, from an idea, import, from GitHub, a template.
- Three tabs: Documents, Ideas, Shared with me.
- The empty state names the free caps once and says you can drop a folder anywhere.

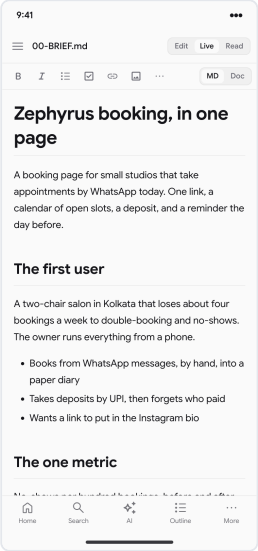
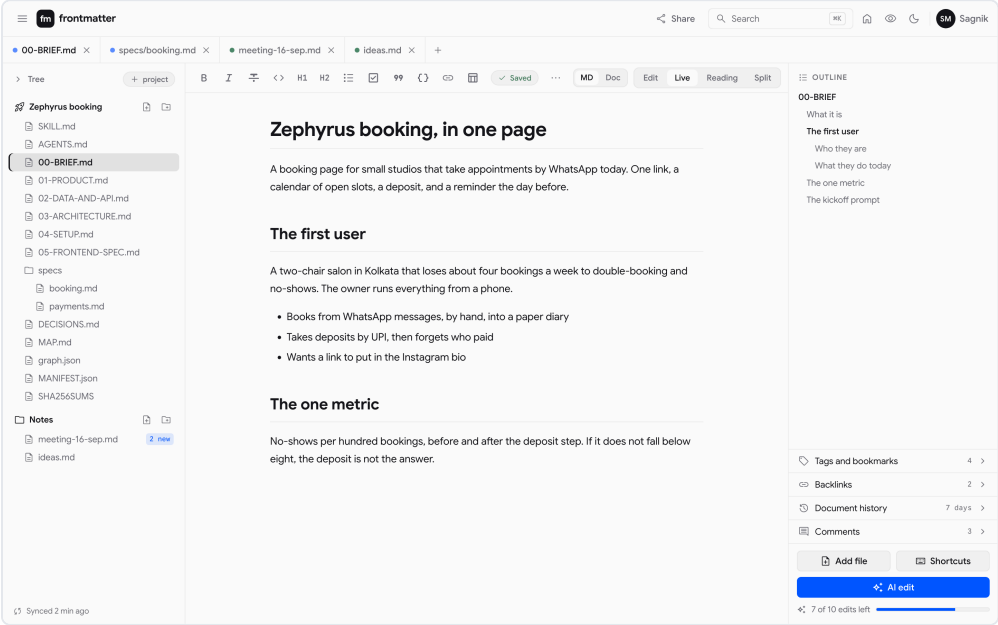
S03. Home



- Recent documents with project, opened and owner. The Ideas tab carries a count.
- A quiet pill shows cloud documents used against the cap.
- The phone shows four starts and the list.

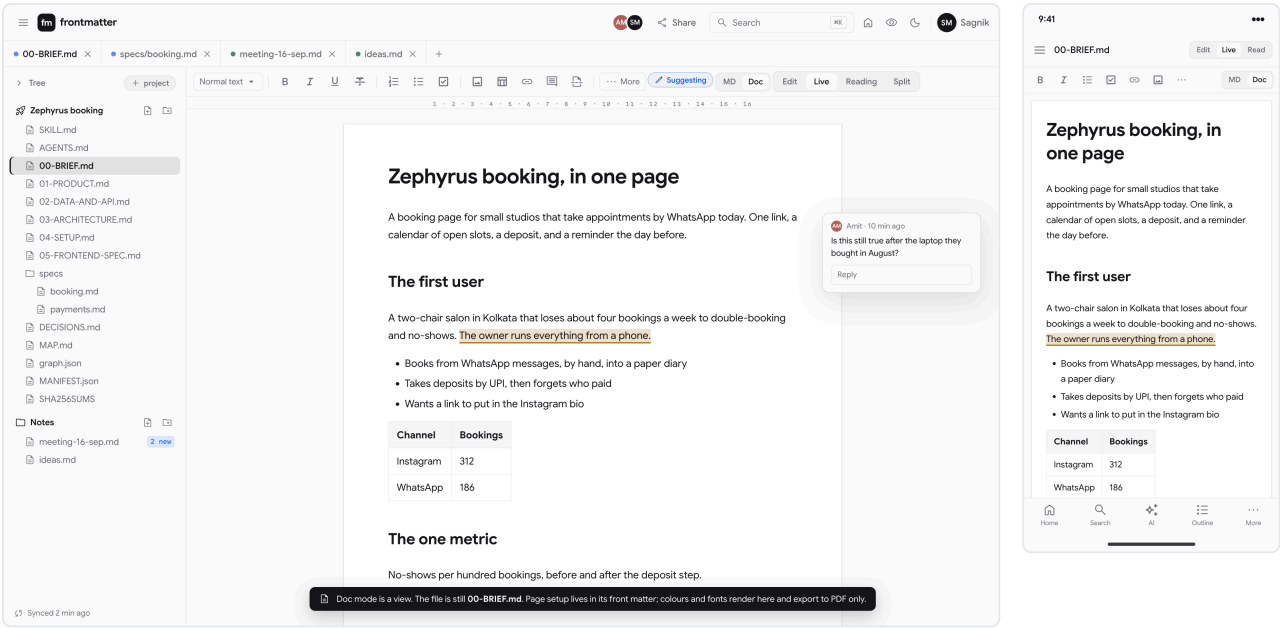
§4 Writing

S04. Workspace



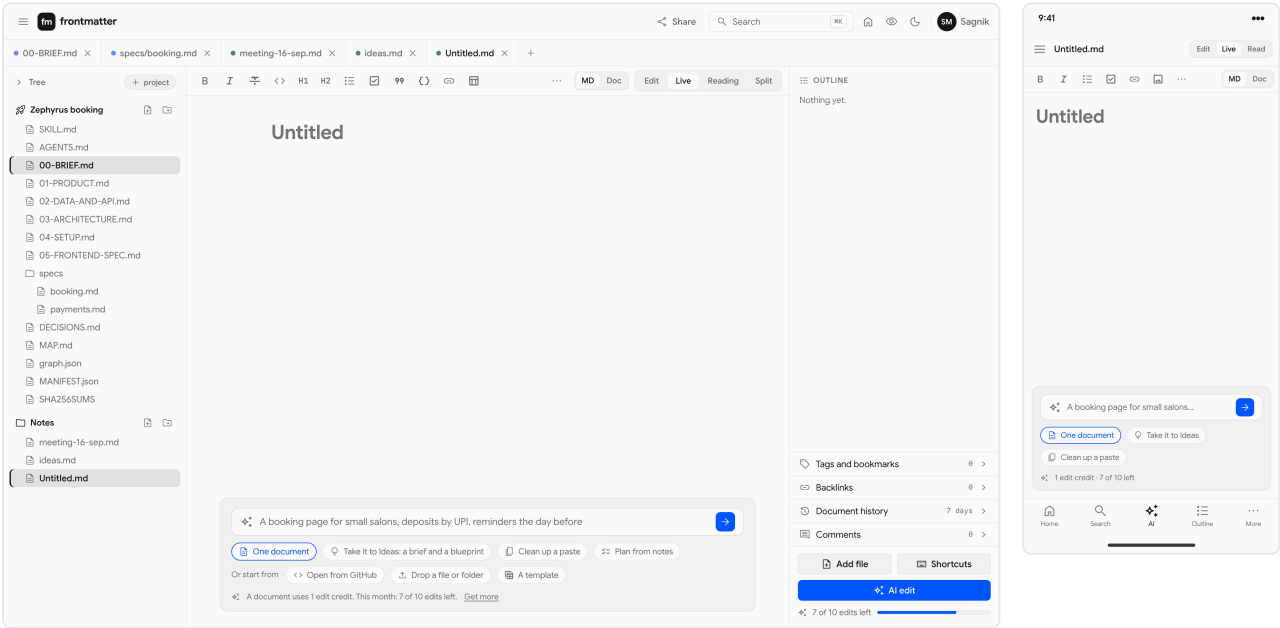
- The shipped layout, measured from source: tabs, the twelve-button toolbar, the four modes, the tree and the outline rail.
- The tree shows all fifteen blueprint files (F019). The history row reads "7 days" on Free (F018). The right cluster folds bookmark, search and history into More so the mode segment fits at 1,440 px (F021).
- The phone keeps the toolbar to seven tools and puts the mode segment in the header.

S05. Doc mode



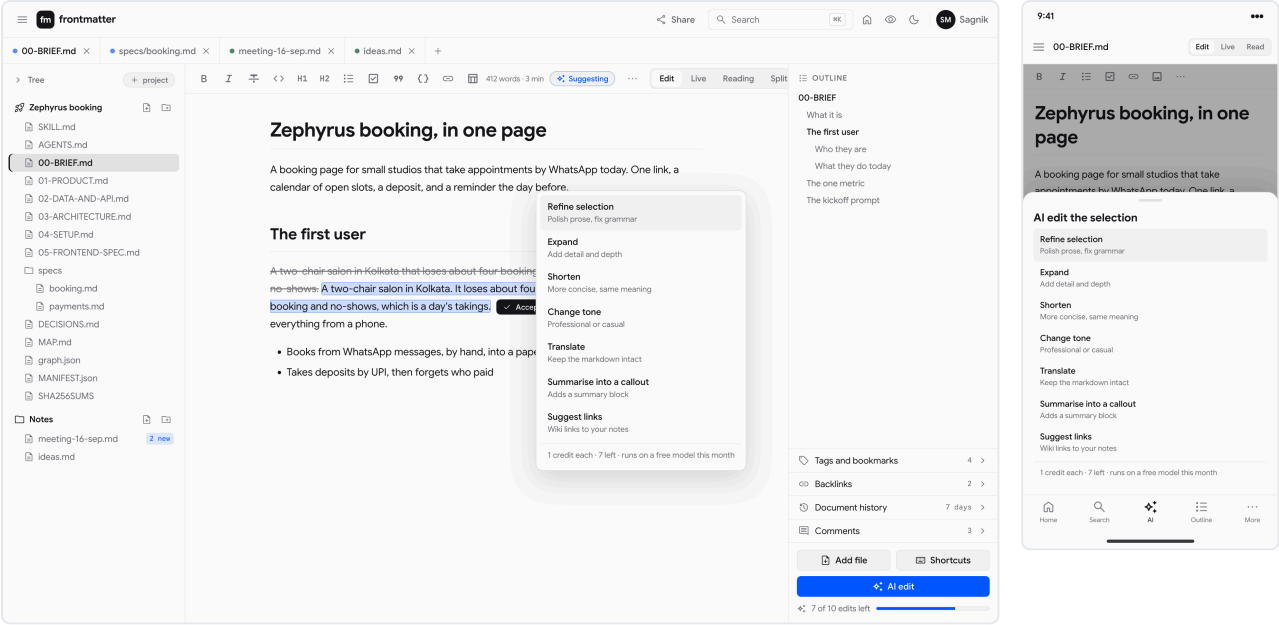
- The Google-Docs-shaped toolbar's first level: style, bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, lists, checklist, image, table, link, comment, page break. Font, size, colour, highlight and alignment sit behind More (F020).
- A paper surface with a ruler. Comments in the margin. Suggesting mode.
- One toast, once: Doc mode is a view; the file is still 00-BRIEF.md; page setup lives in its front matter; colours and fonts render here and export to PDF only.

S06. AI writing box



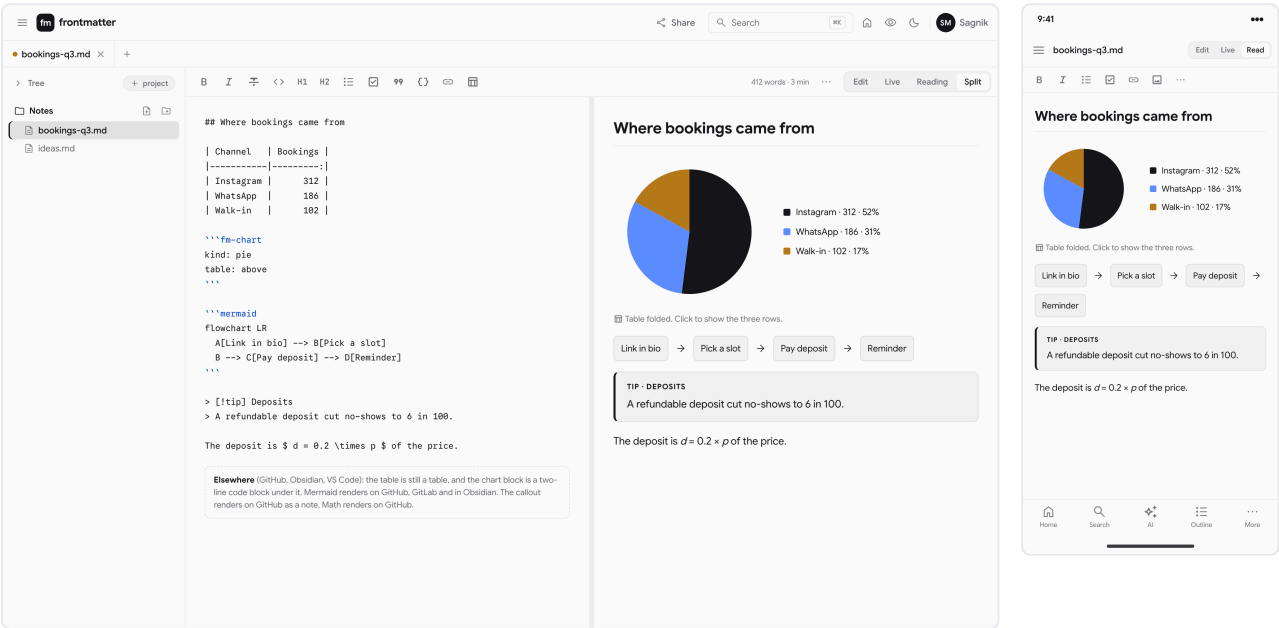
- One box on an empty document. Four chips for the common asks. A second row for the other ways to start.
- The cost is stated before the click: one edit credit, seven of ten left. The rail counts are zero on an empty document (F022).
- Taking it to Ideas is a chip, not a second product.

S07. AI edit



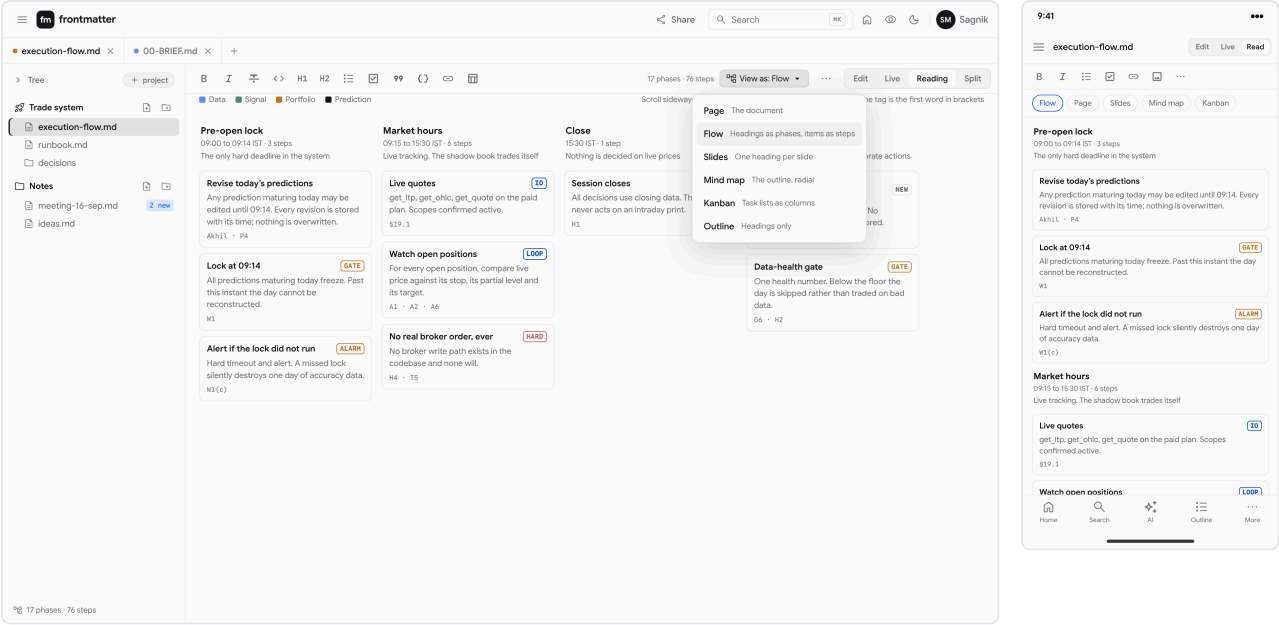
- Seven verbs on a selection. The suggestion appears in place with Accept and Reject of equal weight next to it.
- The menu says which provider the month runs on.
- On the phone the menu is a sheet.

S08. Custom blocks



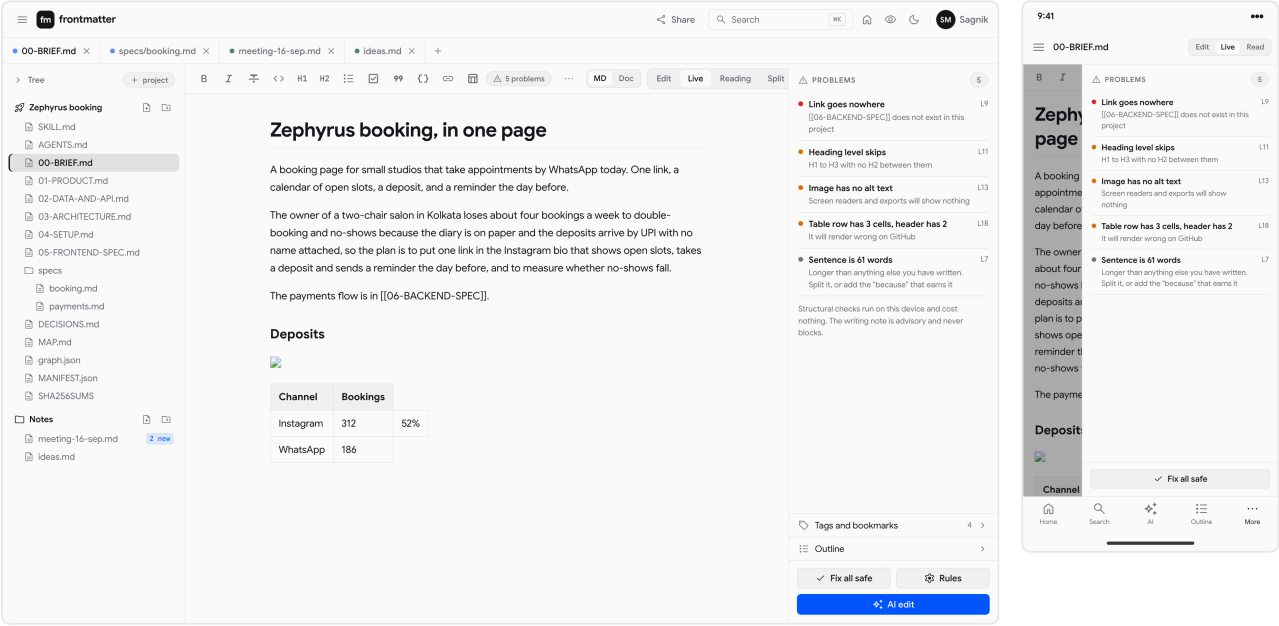
- Split view. A table, a chart block that reads the table above it, a Mermaid flowchart, a callout, maths.
- The left pane states what each block becomes elsewhere: GitHub, Obsidian, VS Code.
- The phone shows the rendered side.

S09. Flow view



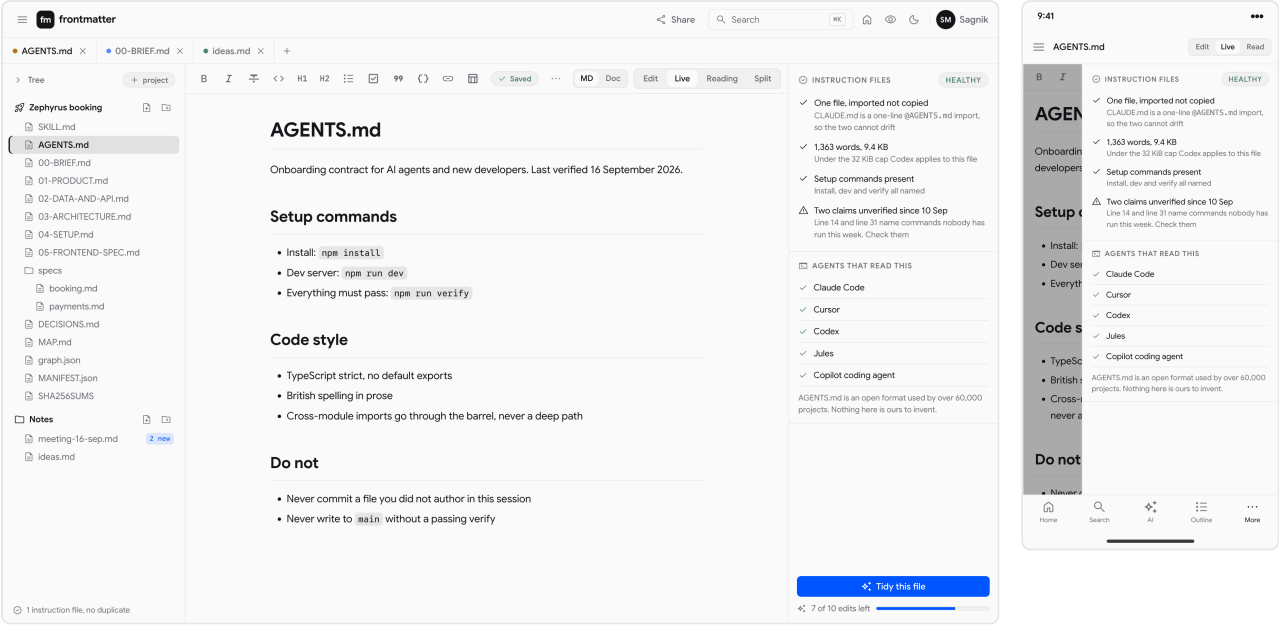
- View as: Page, Flow, Slides, Mind map, Kanban, Outline.
- Flow reads the document as phases and steps: an H2 is a phase, an H3 is a step, a bracketed first word is the tag, a trailing line is the reference.
- A legend for the lanes. Scrolls sideways with the arrow keys.

S10. Problems



- Broken links, heading skips, missing alt text, table shape, and one advisory writing note, each true of the document shown (F022).
- Fix all safe. Rules.
- Structural checks run on the device and cost nothing.

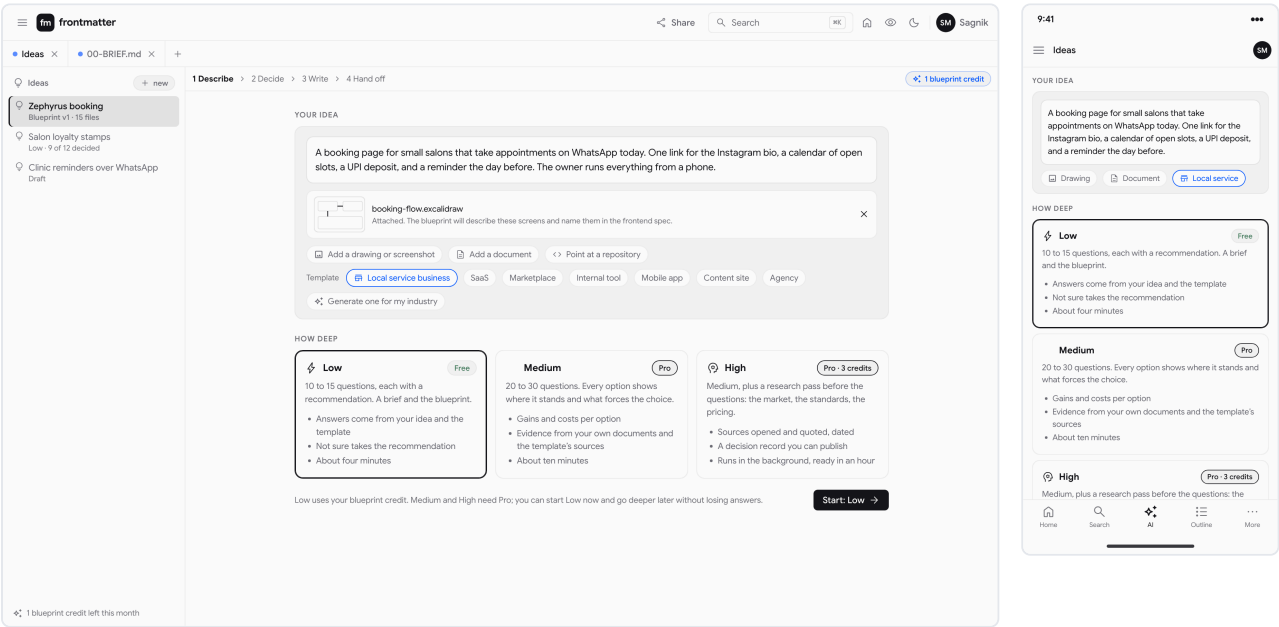
S11. Instruction files



- AGENTS.md with a health panel: one file imported not copied, size under the 32 KiB cap, setup commands present, claims not verified this week.
- The agents that read it. The tree shows the full kit (F019).
- Tidy this file, one credit.

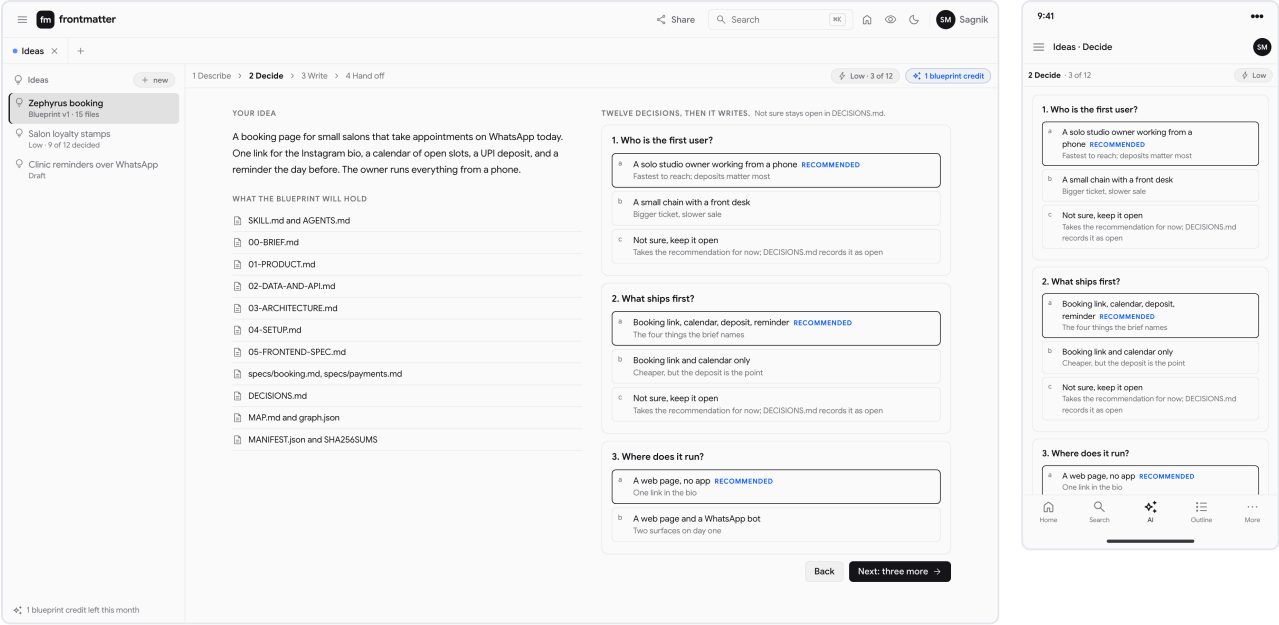
\$5 Ideas

S12. Ideas



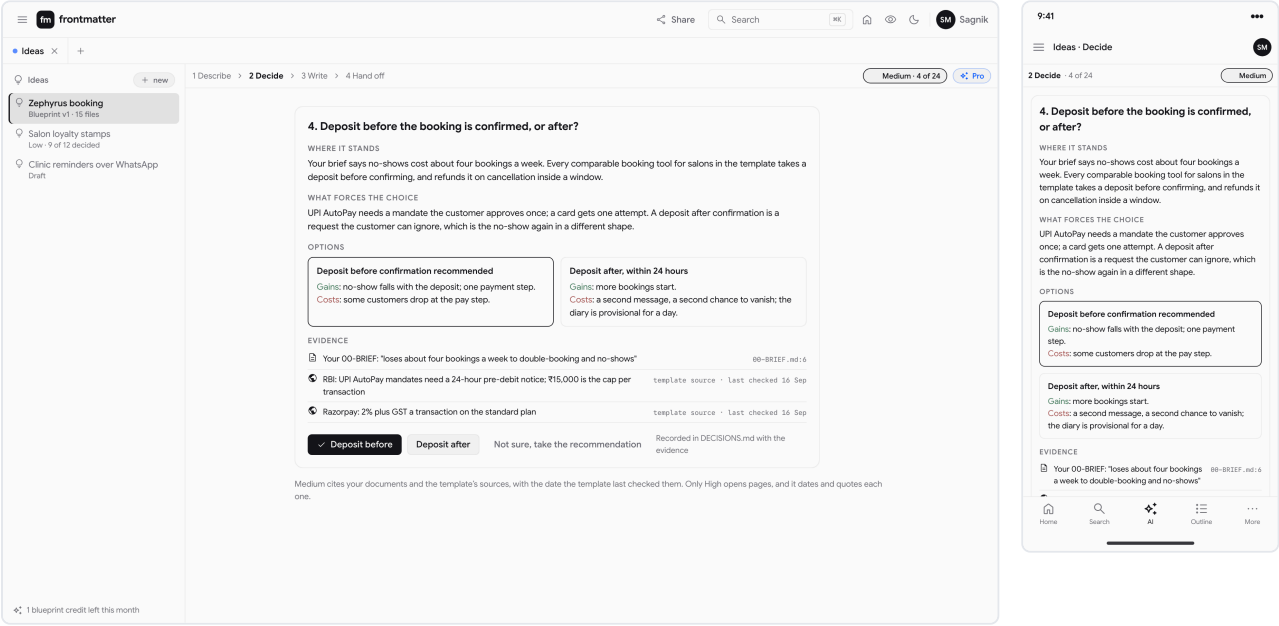
- Ideas listed on the left with their state: draft, decided so far, blueprint version.
- The idea, an attached drawing, a document or a repository. An industry template, or one generated for your industry. The drawing is described in the frontend spec the kit now carries (F025).
- The depth chooser: Low free, Medium Pro, High Pro plus credits. Start at Low and go deeper later without losing answers.

S13. Idea mode, Low



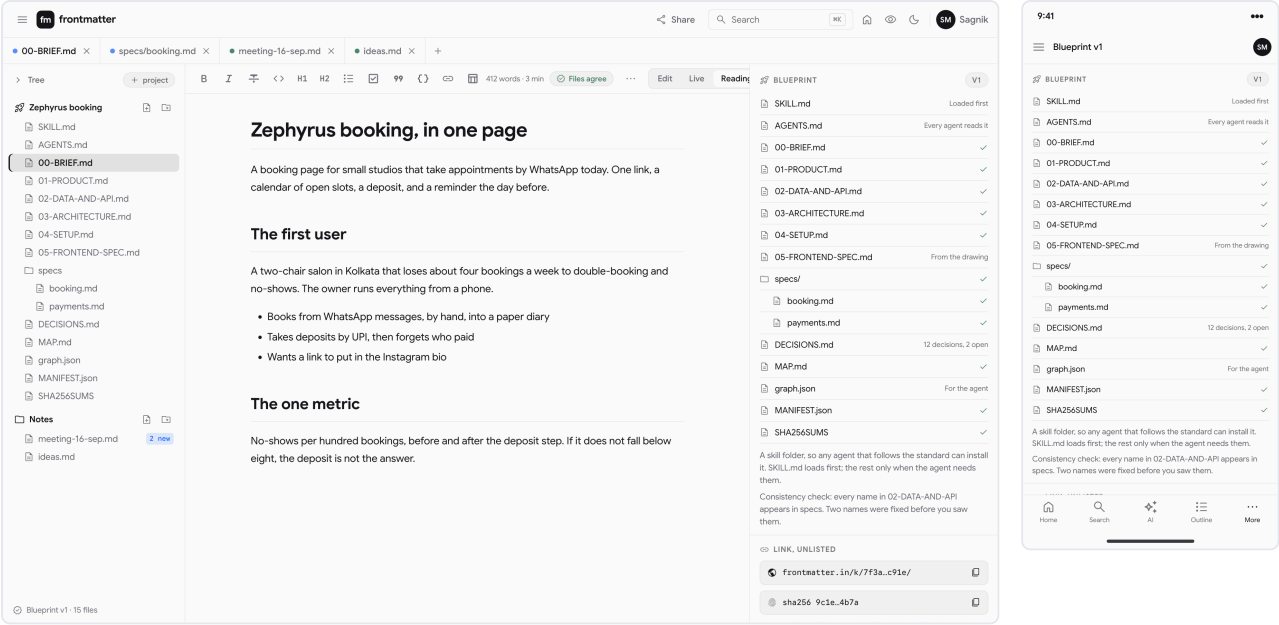
- Twelve decisions in pages of three. Each has a recommendation. Not sure records the question as open and takes the recommendation for now; DECISIONS.md carries it as open, not as decided.
- The blueprint's fifteen files are listed before a credit is spent.
- Steps: Describe, Decide, Write, Hand off.

S14. Idea mode, Medium and High



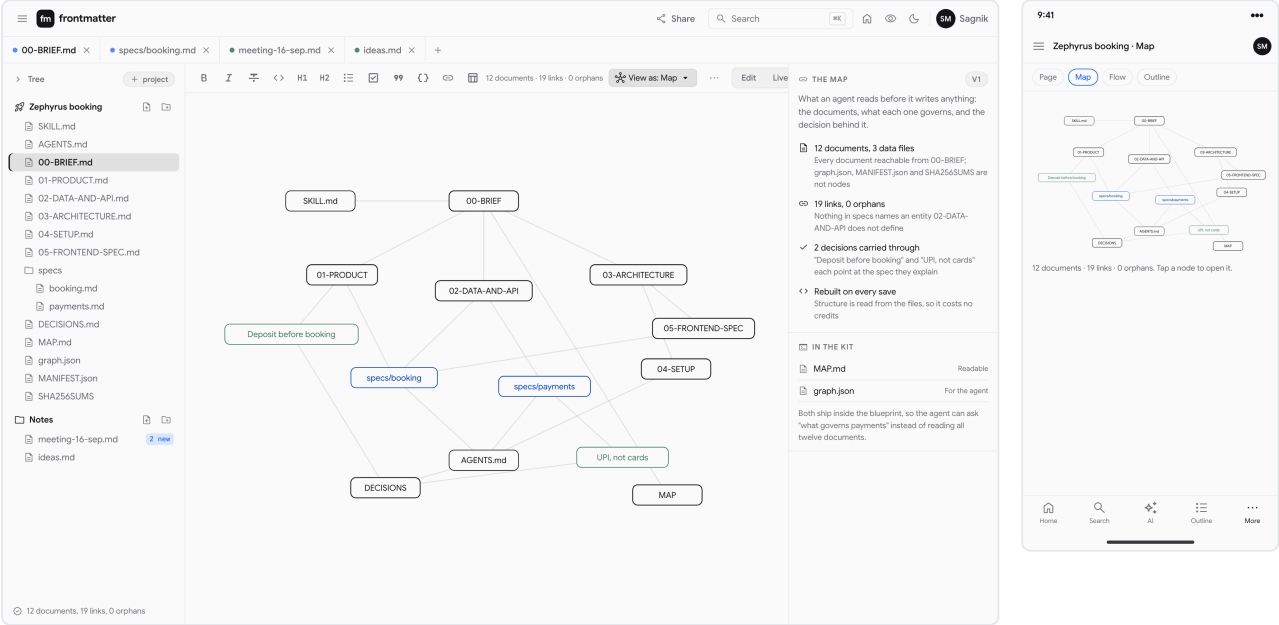
- A decision card: where it stands, what forces the choice, options with gains and costs, evidence rows, the recommendation. On Medium the web rows are labelled as the template's sources with the date they were last checked; only High opens pages (F037).
- The answer is recorded in DECISIONS.md with its evidence.
- High adds a research pass before this step, run in the background.

S15. Blueprint ready



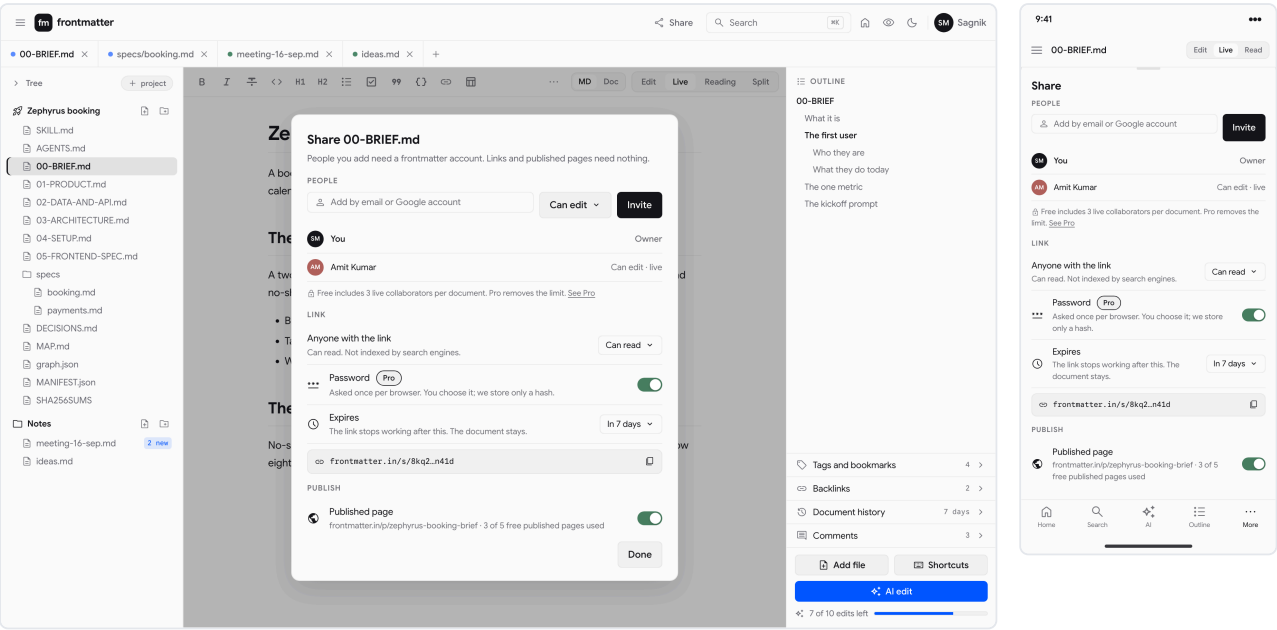
- Fifteen files in a skill folder: SKILL.md loads first, AGENTS.md, the numbered documents including the frontend spec, specs, DECISIONS.md, MAP.md, graph.json, the manifest and checksums.
- A consistency check ran before you saw it. An unlisted link. A kickoff prompt for Claude Code, Cursor or Codex that verifies the tarball against the hash printed on this page before it unpacks, and reads before it builds (F028).
- Edit, then publish v2.

S16. The map



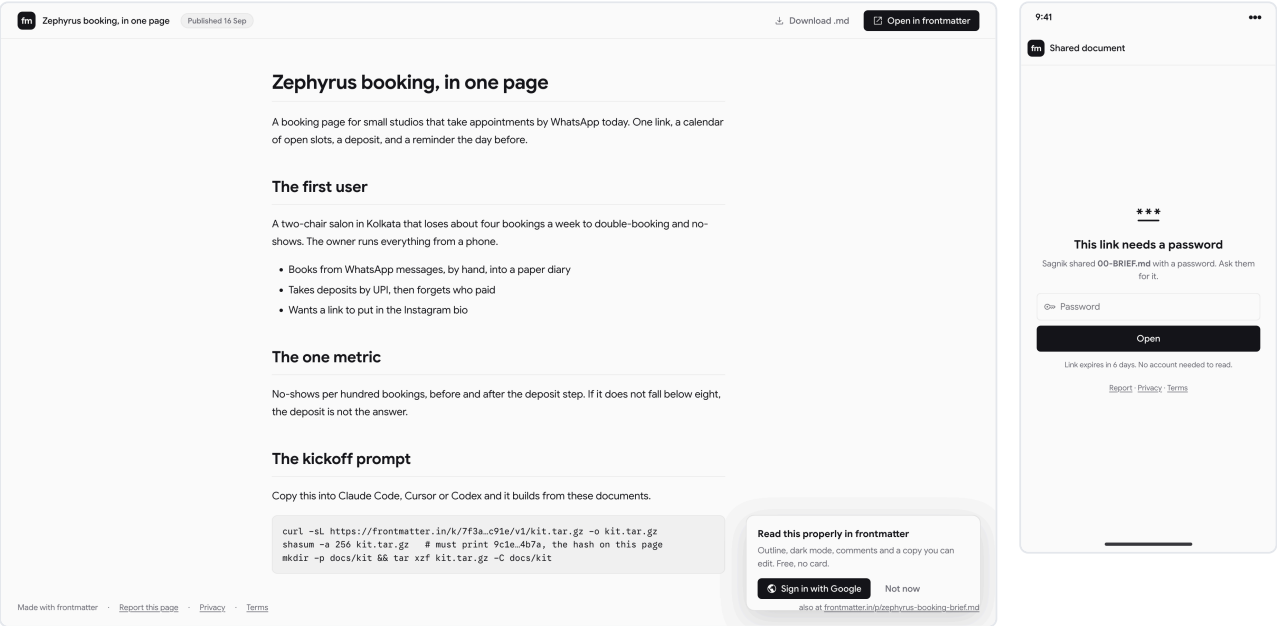
- The documents, what each governs, the decisions behind them, and the instruction file, as a graph. The map counts twelve markdown documents; the three data files are not nodes (F038).
- Rebuilt on every save from the files, so it costs no credits.
- MAP.md and graph.json ship inside the kit.

S17. Share



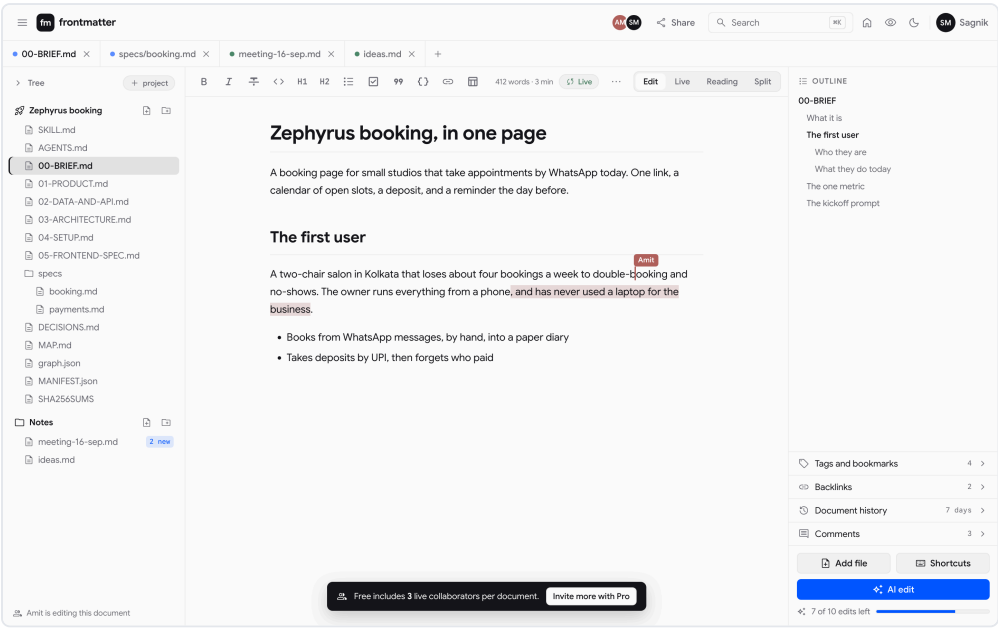
- People, with a role from the matrix in section 19. Three live collaborators on Free.
- A link that can read, expire, or need a password on Pro.
- The published page toggle, with pages used against the cap.

S18. Published page



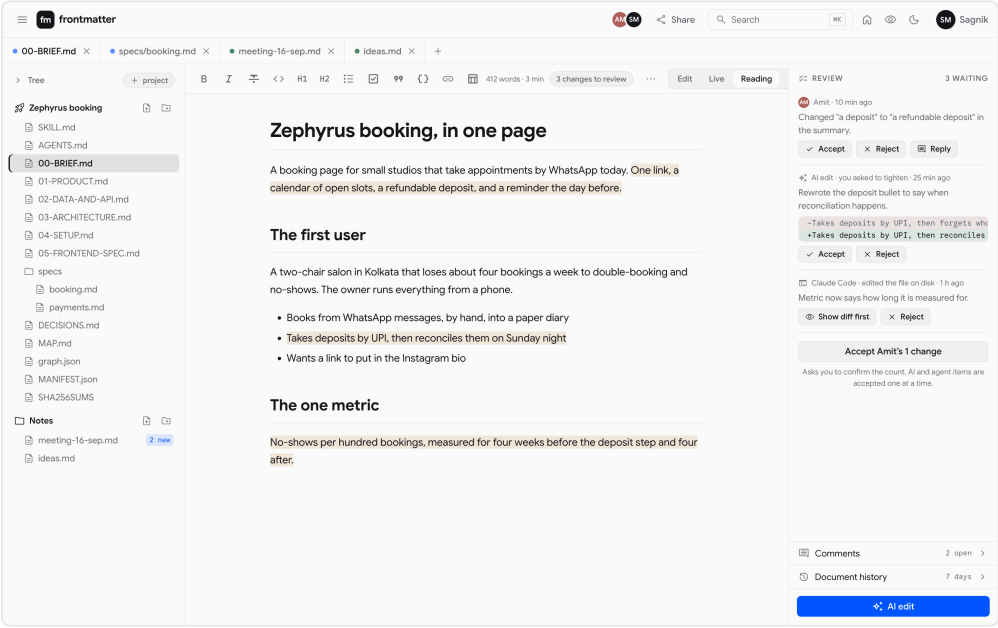
- Reads without an account. Download the markdown. Open in frontmatter. A quiet card offers sign-in once.
- The footer carries Report, Privacy, Terms and the `.md` twin (F033).
- The phone shows the password gate a reader meets on a protected link, with the same footer.

S19. Live collaboration

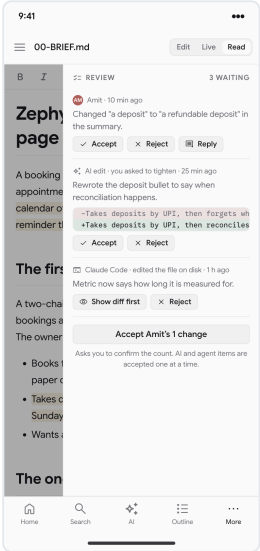
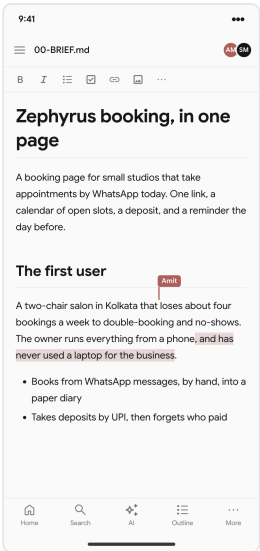


- Presence avatars, a named cursor, the other person's text highlighted as it lands.
- The toast states the free limit once.
- On the phone, presence sits in the header.

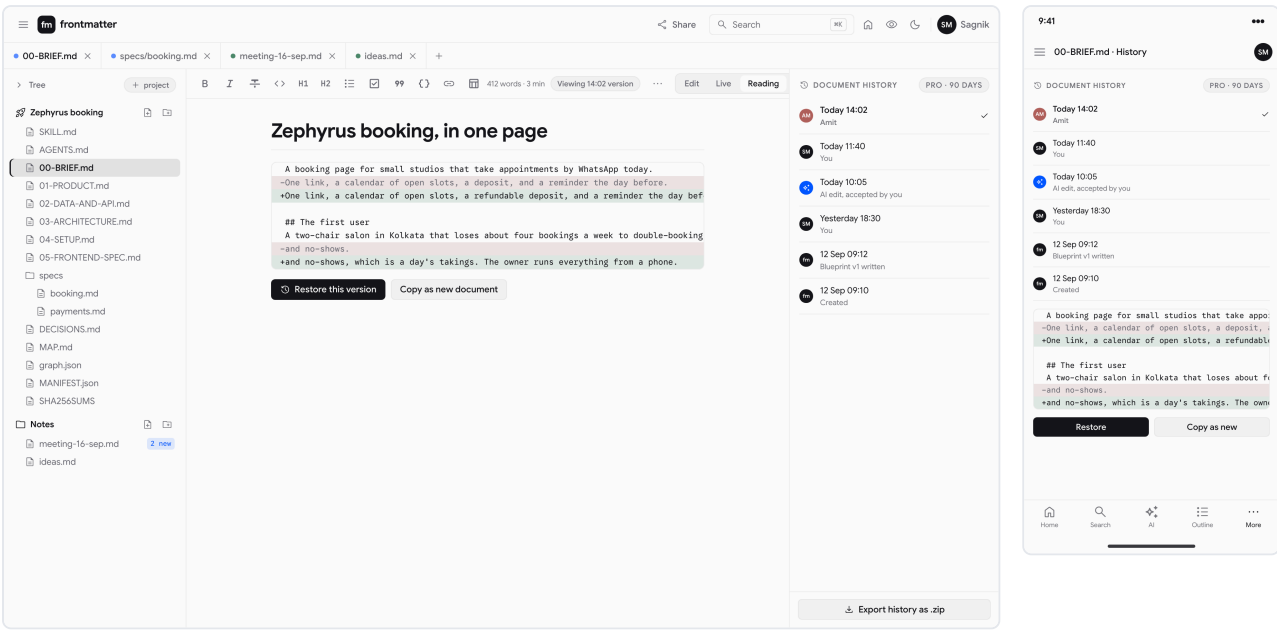
S20. Document review



- Changes waiting, each with who made it: a person, an AI edit you asked for, or an agent that edited the file on disk through the desktop folder.
- Accept, Reject and Reply of equal weight. Accept all applies only to a named person's edits and asks you to confirm the count first; AI and agent items are accepted one by one with the diff shown (F029).
- Changed spans highlighted in the document.



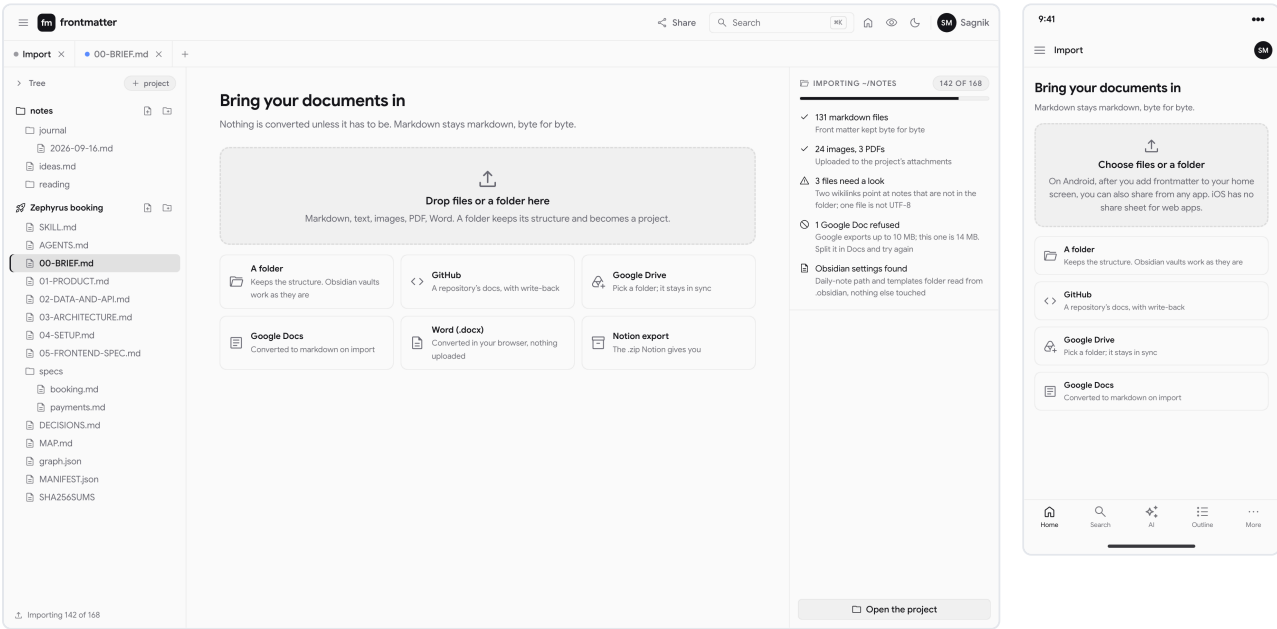
S21. Document history



- Every version with its author, including the AI edit and the blueprint write.
- A diff against the current version. Restore, or copy as a new document.
- Seven days on Free, 90 on Pro.

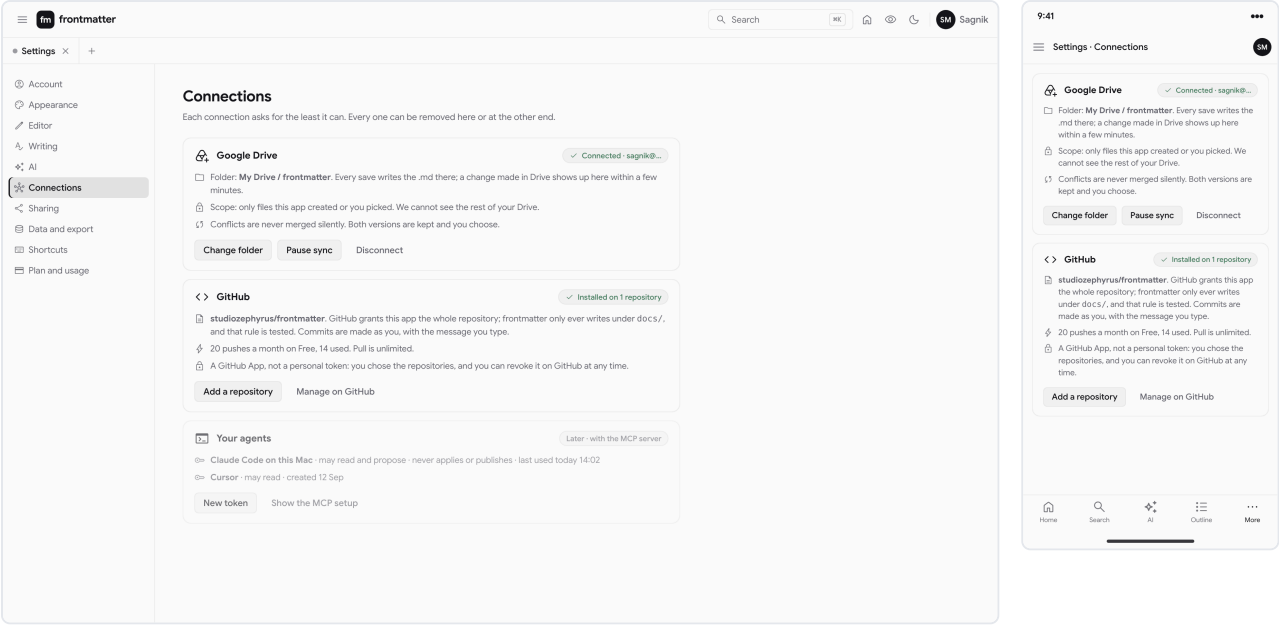
§7 Bringing things in and out

S22. Import



- Drop files or a folder. A folder keeps its structure and becomes a project.
- Six sources: a folder, GitHub, Google Drive, Google Docs, Word, a Notion export. A Google Doc over 10 MB is refused with the reason (F024).
- The progress panel says what was kept byte for byte, what was uploaded, and what needs a look. On the phone, sharing from another app is offered after install on Android and said plainly to be absent on iOS (F036).

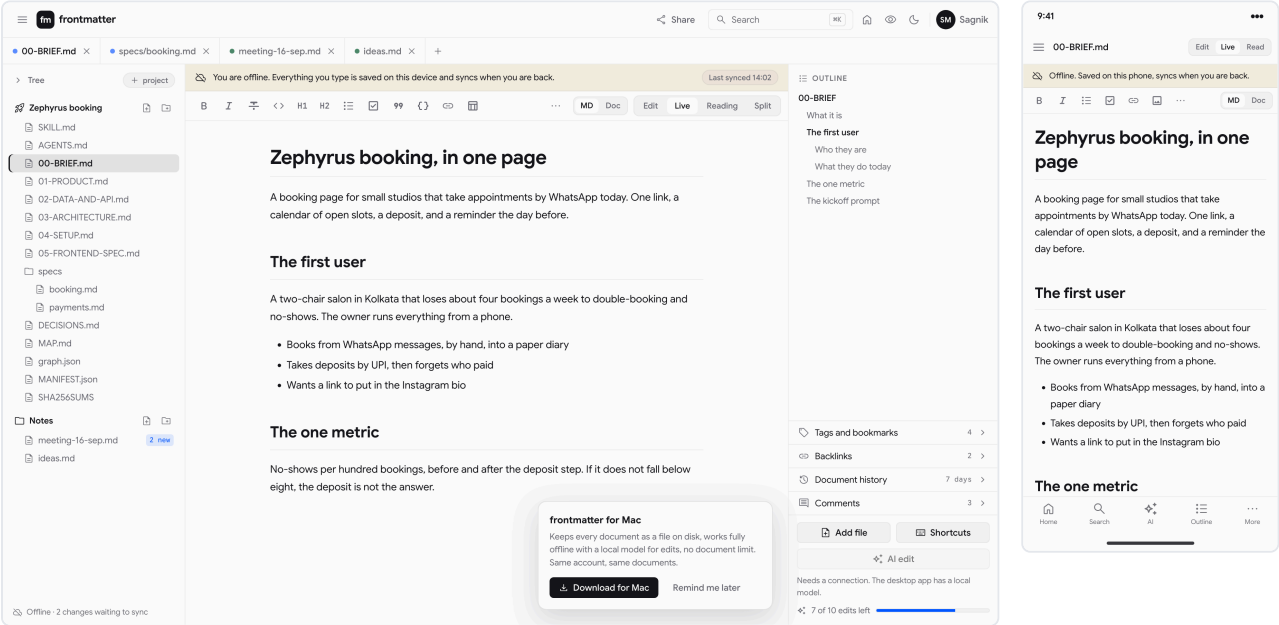
S23. Connections



- Google Drive: the folder, the scope, the conflict rule, "a change in Drive shows up here within a few minutes" (F027). Change folder, pause, disconnect.
- GitHub: "GitHub grants this app the whole repository; frontmatter only ever writes under docs/" (F034). Pushes used, revocable on GitHub.
- Your agents: marked Later, with the MCP server (F035).

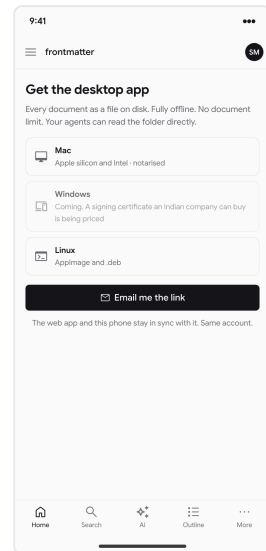
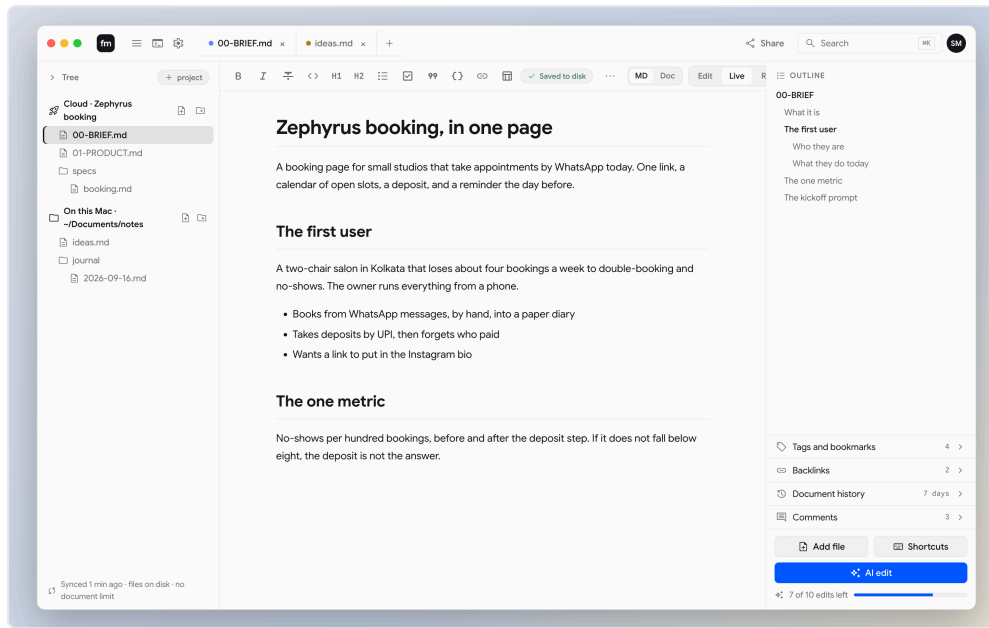
§8 Everywhere

S24. Offline



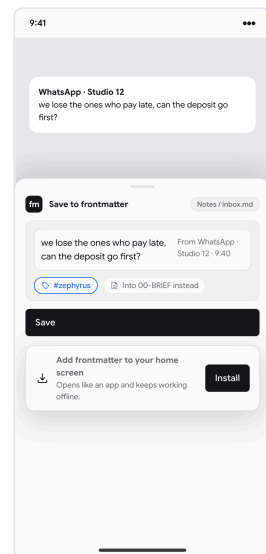
- A banner, last synced time, changes waiting.
- AI edit is disabled with a one-line reason; on the desktop the local model takes over (F039).
- The desktop card: files on disk, fully offline, no document limit.

S25. Desktop app



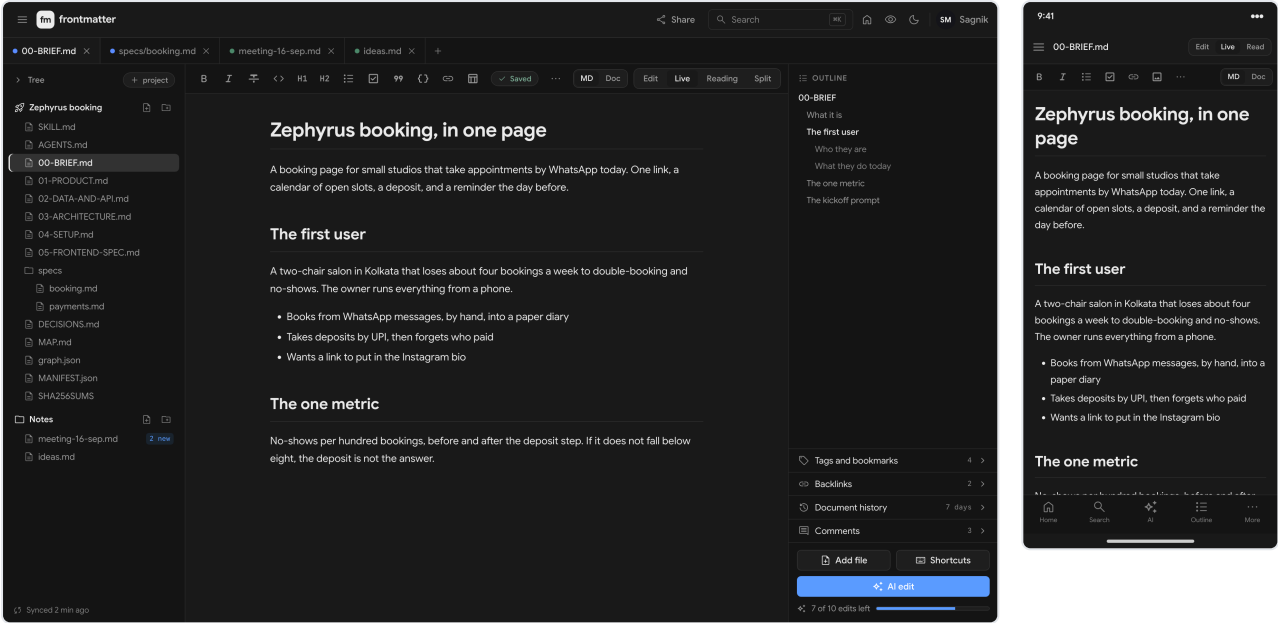
- Cloud projects and folders on this Mac in one tree. Saved to disk.
- The same header, tabs and toolbar as the web.
- The phone page emails you the download link: Mac now, Linux unsigned, Windows coming (F047).

S26. Quick capture



- A global shortcut opens one box that saves into an inbox note. No credits.
- On the phone, the share sheet from any app lands in the same inbox, on Android after install.
- The install card appears once.

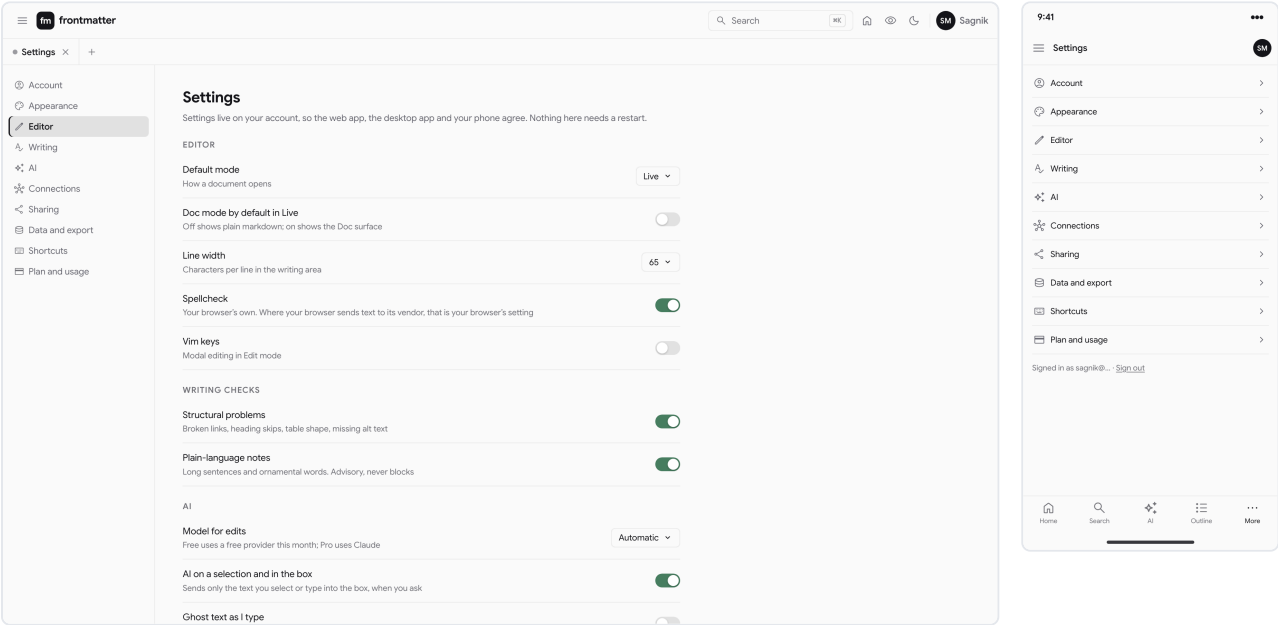
S27. Dark mode



- The same workspace on the dark tokens from globals.css.
- One toggle in the header, remembered on the account.

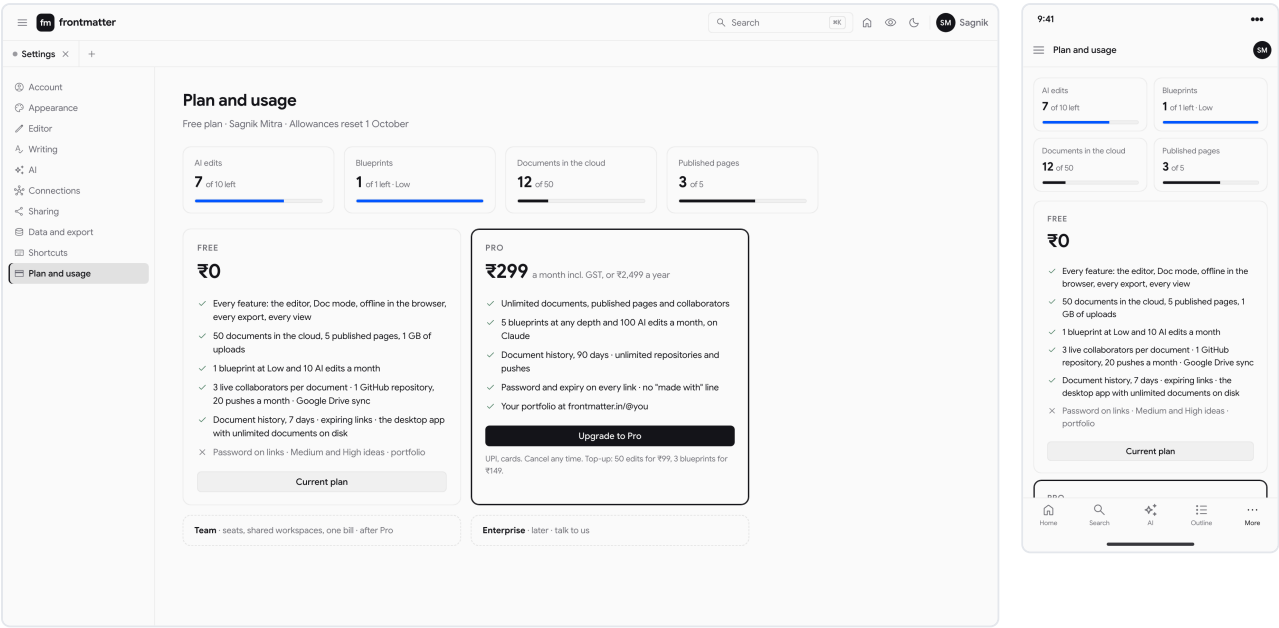
§9 Account

S28. Settings



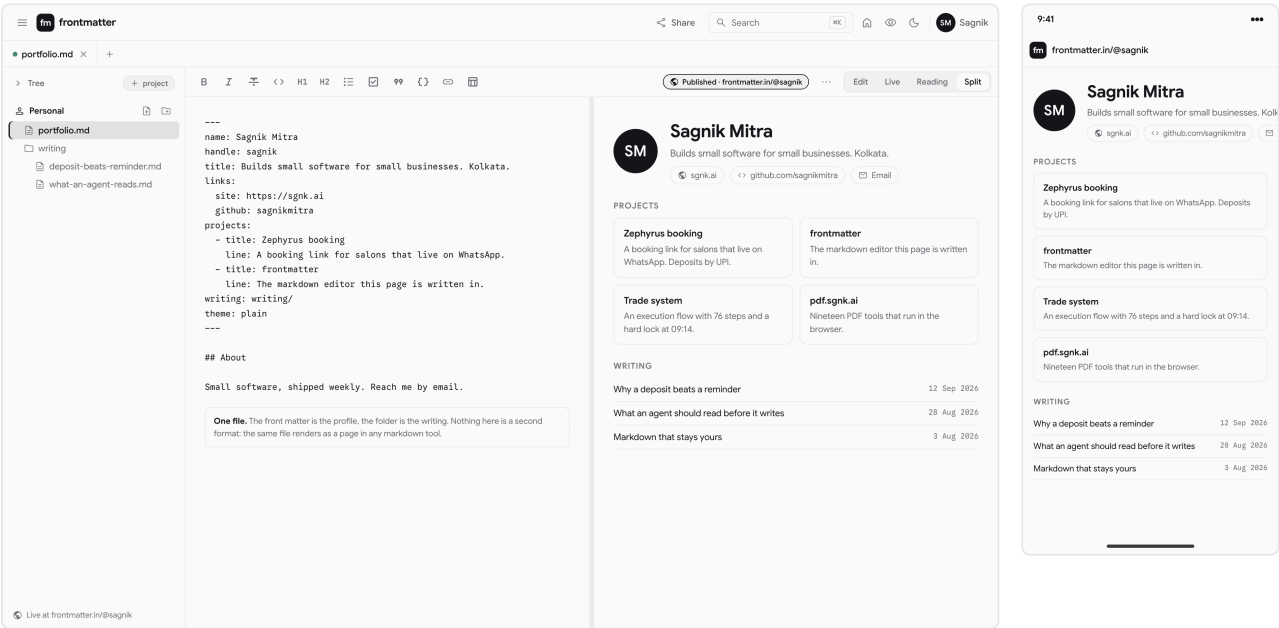
- Ten sections, from Account and Appearance through Editor, Writing, AI, Connections and Sharing to Data and export, Shortcuts and Plan and usage.
- Spellcheck says it is the browser's own (F048). Two AI switches: ghost text as you type, off by default, and AI on a selection or in the box (F049). Mark AI text in the version record.
- Settings live on the account, so every device agrees.

S29. Plan and usage



- Four meters: edits, blueprints, cloud documents, published pages. "Allowances reset 1 October" (F053).
- Free and Pro side by side, the price marked GST inclusive (F051). Team and Enterprise named as coming.
- UPI and cards, cancel any time, top-ups.

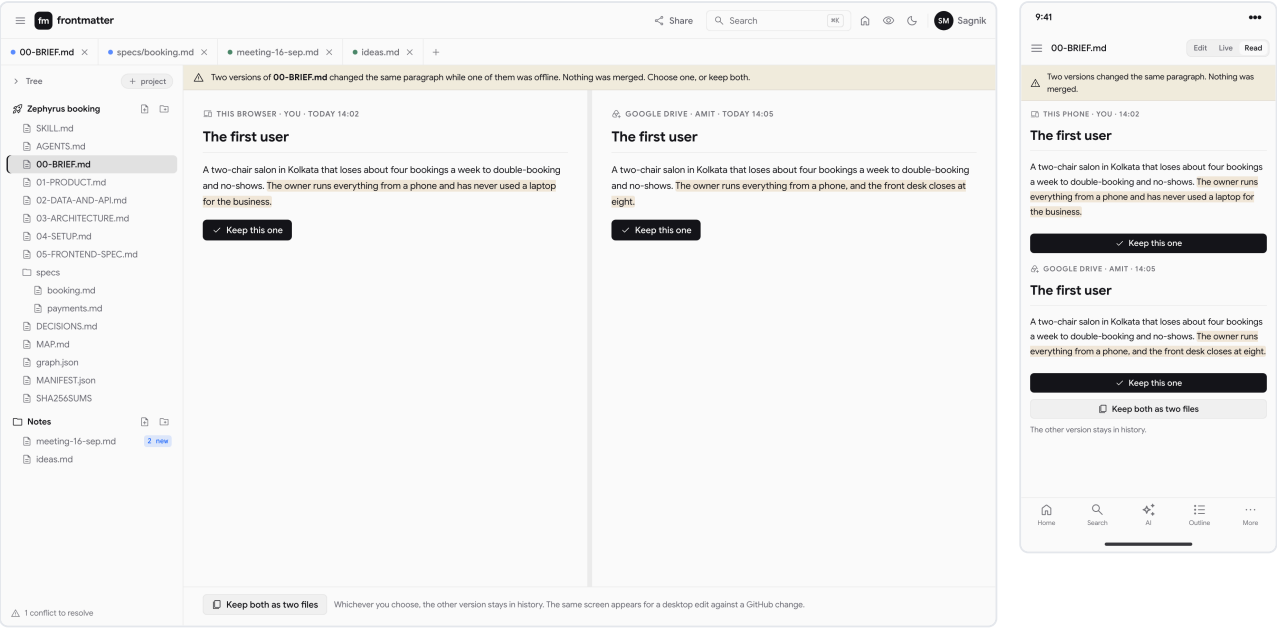
S30. Portfolio



- One file, portfolio.md. The front matter keys are name, handle, title, links, projects, writing and theme, the same list section 10 specifies (F052). The H2 sections are the page, the writing folder is the blog.
- Published at frontmatter.in/@handle, served from the stored file, no build step. No Follow button; there is no social feature in this plan.
- Pro, and late.

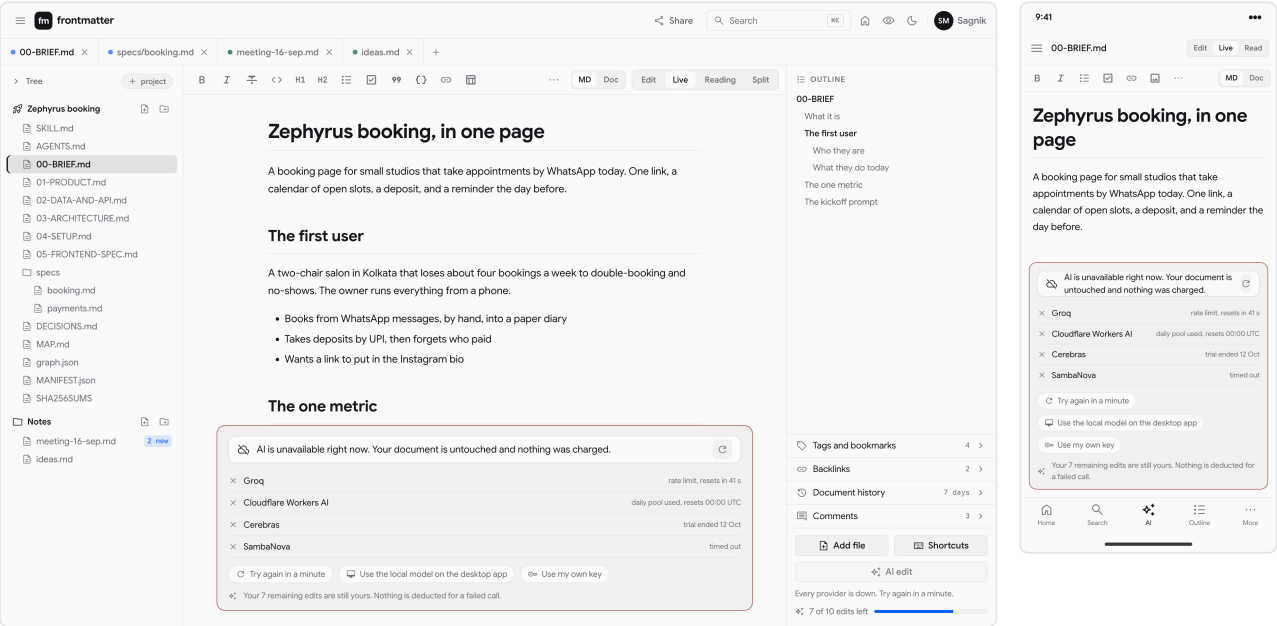
§10 The states nobody wants, drawn anyway

S31. Conflict



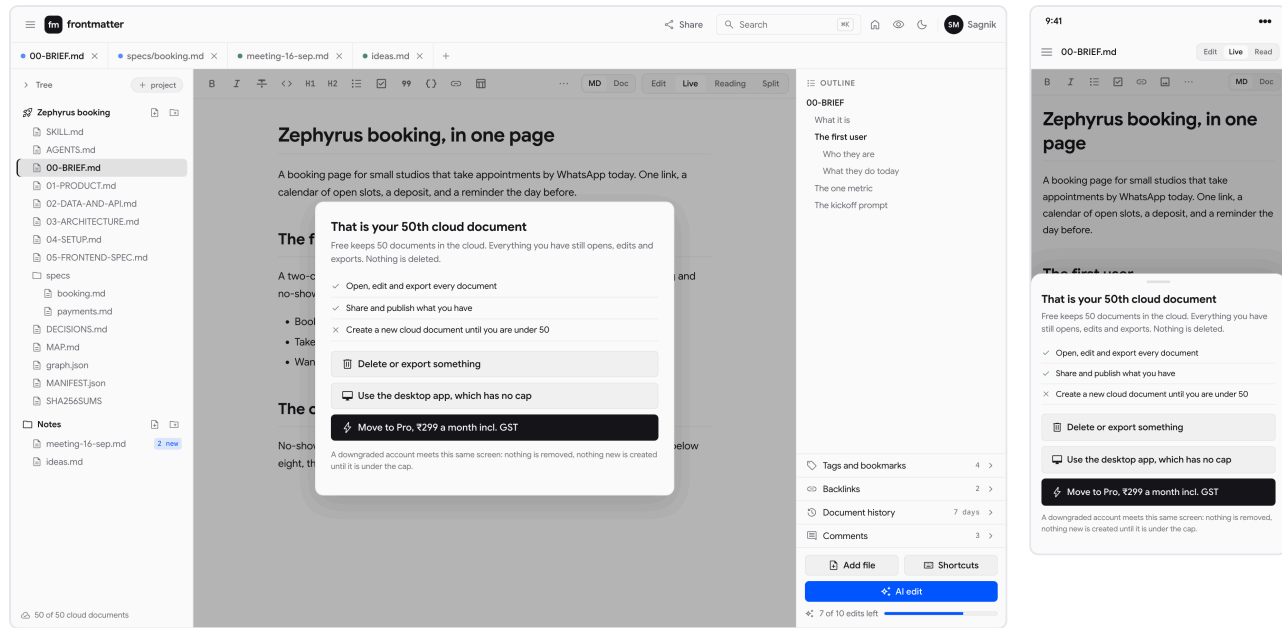
- Two versions of the same document side by side, each with its author, device and time. Nothing was merged.
- Keep left, keep right, or keep both as two files. The other version is always in history.
- The same screen serves a Drive edit against a web edit and a desktop edit against a GitHub change.

S32. AI unavailable



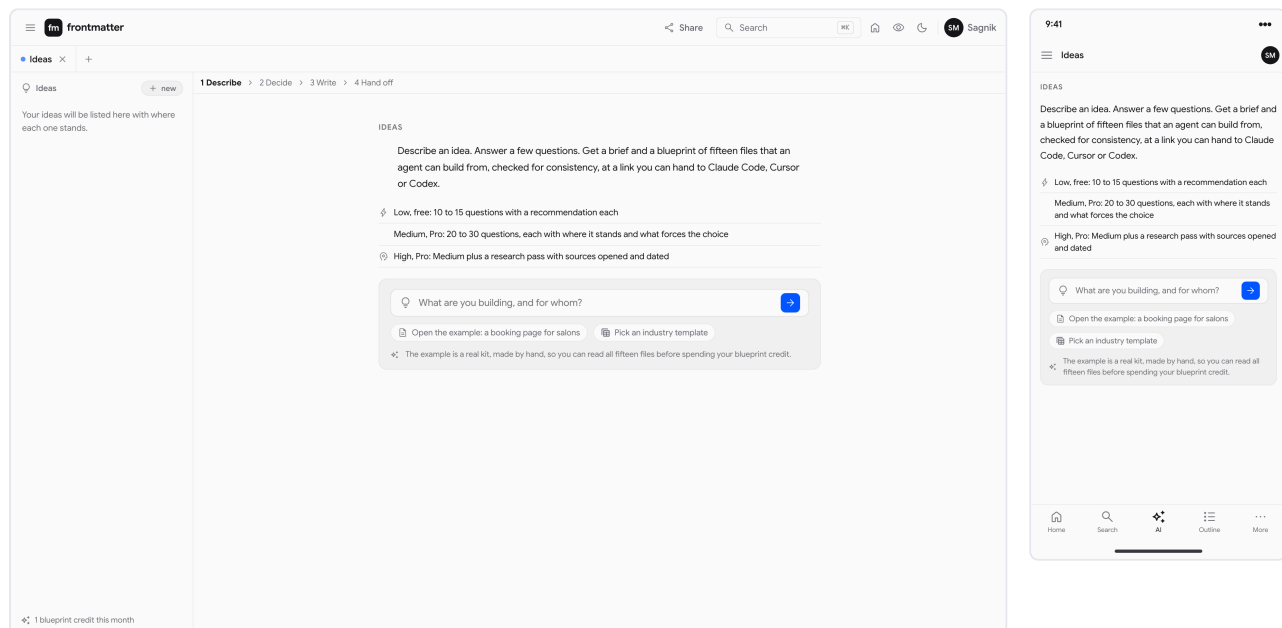
- The AI box when every provider in the chain has refused or timed out: the document is untouched, nothing was charged, try again in a minute, or on the desktop use the local model.
- The status of each provider in the chain, so the person knows it is not their document.

S33. Over the cap



- What happened: the 50th cloud document, or the tenth edit, or the fifth page. What still works: every document opens, edits and exports.
- What to do: delete or export something, wait for the reset, or move to Pro. The desktop app has no cap and is named.
- A downgraded account meets the same screen: nothing is deleted, nothing new is created until under the cap.

S34. Ideas, empty



- The Ideas tab before the first idea: what a blueprint is in one line, the three depths in one line each, and one box to start.
- One hand-made example kit to open and read, so the person sees the fifteen files before spending a credit.